

Word family: **sound / sounded / sounding / soundly / soundness**

Base word: sound

Past tense: sounded

Past participle: sounded

Related forms: sounding, soundly, soundness

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective (形容詞) / adverb-related form (相關副詞)

Your sentence:

> “At the same time, the ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and **sound quality**, so it still felt believable.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **sound** means **audio — what you hear**, especially the audio produced by the headphones.

sound quality means how clear, balanced, rich, accurate, or pleasant that audio is.

繁體中文: 耳機所播放出來、能被人聽見的音訊／聲音；sound quality 指這些聲音在清晰度、平衡度、細節和整體聽感方面的質素

中文翻譯:

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and sound quality...”

「廣告亦提到了舒適度、電池續航力和**音質**等實際功能特點.....」

sound quality = 聲音／音訊呈現得有多清晰、自然、平衡和悅耳的整體質素

1. **sound = something that can be heard (可聽見的東西) — 聲音；聲響**

This is the central noun meaning.

Meaning: Something that you can hear.

Practice 1

> “I heard a strange **sound** outside.”

「我聽到外面傳來一陣奇怪的**聲響**。」

Practice 2

> “The **sound** of rain helped me relax.”

「雨水的**聲音**令我放鬆下來。」

sound = 人耳能夠聽到的聲音或聲響

2. **sound** = audio produced by music/device (音樂／裝置輸出的音訊) — 聲音; 音響效果

This is the meaning behind **sound quality** in your original sentence.

Meaning: The audio produced by a speaker, headphone, instrument, recording, etc.

Practice 3 — Original context

> “The ad mentioned comfort, battery life, and **sound quality**.”

「廣告提到了舒適度、電池續航力和**音質**。」

Practice 4

> “These headphones produce a warm, detailed **sound**.”

「這副耳機能呈現**溫暖而細節豐富的聲音效果**。」

Practice 5

> “I prefer the **sound** of these speakers.”

「我比較喜歡這些揚聲器的**整體聲音表現**。」

sound — audio = 音響設備、耳機、樂器或錄音所呈現出的可聽音訊

3. **sound** = particular auditory character (聲音的特質／風格) — 音色; 聲音風格

Meaning: The distinctive way a voice, instrument, band, or recording sounds.

Practice 6

> “The band has developed its own distinctive **sound**.”

「這支樂隊已經形成自己獨特的**音樂聲音風格／音色特色**。」

Practice 7

> “She wanted a softer **sound** for the recording.”

「她希望錄音呈現更**柔和的聲音風格**。」

****sound = 某個聲音來源具有辨識度的音色、風格或整體聽感****

This is closely related to #2, so I would treat them as branches of the broader ****audio**** sense rather than completely unrelated meanings.

4. ****sound = impression created by words/idea (說話／構思給人的感覺) — 聽起來的感覺／印象****

Here, ****sound**** is usually a verb.

****Meaning:**** To give a particular impression when heard or described.

Practice 8

> “That ****sounds**** like a good idea.”

「那個構思****聽起來不錯／感覺似乎很好****。」

Practice 9

> “The job ****sounds**** interesting.”

「這份工作****聽起來很有趣****。」

****sound + adjective / sound like = 根據聽到的資料或說法, 給人某種印象****

This does ****not**** necessarily mean literal acoustic sound.

5. ****sound + adjective (人的聲音／語氣) — 聽起來顯得某種情緒或狀態****

****Meaning:**** To appear to be in a particular emotional or physical state based on someone’s voice or words.

Practice 10

> “You **sound tired**.”

「你**聽起來好像很累**。」

Practice 11

> “She **sounded worried** on the phone.”

「她在電話中**聽起來很擔心**。」

sound + adjective = 從某人的聲音或說話方式判斷, 似乎處於某種狀態

Compare:

* **look tired** → 看起來累(視覺)

* **sound tired** → 聽起來累(聲音)

* **feel tired** → 自己感到累

6. **sound like + noun/person/idea (相似的聲音／情況) — 聽起來像.....**

Meaning: To resemble something based on what is heard or described.

Practice 12

> “That **sounds like** thunder.”

「那聲音**聽起來像雷聲**。」

Practice 13

> “It **sounds like** you had a difficult day.”

「聽你這樣說, **看來你今天過得很辛苦**。」

sound like = 從聲音或所聽到的資訊判斷, 像某人／某物／某種情況

The second example is figurative: it is not comparing literal sounds.

7. **sound = produce/make a sound (物件／警報／聲音來源) — 發出聲音; 鳴響**

Meaning: To produce or cause a sound to be heard.

Practice 14

> “The alarm **sounded** at six in the morning.”

「警報器早上六時**響起**。」

Practice 15

> “A bell **sounded** in the distance.”

「遠處傳來鐘聲／一個鐘**響了起來**。」

sound = 發出可以被聽見的聲音

8. **sound + alarm/warning (警報／警示) — 發出警報; 敲響警鐘**

Meaning: To cause an alarm, warning, horn, etc. to make a sound; figuratively, to warn people about danger.

Practice 16

> “The guard **sounded the alarm**.”

「警衛**拉響了警報**。」

Practice 17

> “Doctors have **sounded the alarm** about rising infection rates.”

「醫生已經就感染率上升**發出嚴重警告／敲響警鐘**。」

sound the alarm = 發出警報; 亦可比喻公開警告某項危險

This fixed expression is useful enough to include even though the second use is figurative.

9. **sound = healthy/strong/intact (身體／物件) — 健康的; 完好的; 結實可靠的**

Here, **sound** is an adjective.

Meaning: In good condition, healthy, strong, or free from serious damage or weakness.

Practice 18

> “The building is structurally **sound**.”

「這座建築在結構上**穩固完好**，沒有重大缺陷。」

Practice 19

> “The horse is still physically **sound**.”

「這匹馬的身體仍然**健康良好**、沒有影響活動的傷患。」

sound = 身體、結構或物件狀況良好、穩固而沒有重大缺陷的

10. **sound** = argument/advice/judgment (論點／建議／判斷) sensible and reliable — 合理可靠的；有充分根據的

This is a major figurative adjective meaning.

Meaning: Based on good reasoning, evidence, or judgment and therefore trustworthy.

Practice 20

> “That is **sound** advice.”

「那是**合理可靠**、值得採納的建議。」

Practice 21

> “The conclusion is based on **sound** evidence.”

「這個結論建立在**可靠而有充分根據的證據**上。」

sound advice/argument/reasoning = 有充分理據、邏輯可靠並值得信任的

11. **sound** = business/financial position (企業／財務) stable and reliable — 穩健的；財政健全的

****Meaning:** Financially stable, well managed, and unlikely to fail.**

Practice 22

> “The company is in a ****sound**** financial position.”

「公司的財務狀況****穩健健康****。」

Practice 23

> “They made a ****sound**** investment.”

「他們作出了一項****穩健而合理的投資****。」

****sound — financial/business = 財務穩定、風險控制合理、基礎可靠的****

This develops from the same adjective concept as #9–#10:

> ****free from serious weakness****

12. ****sound = thorough/complete in “sound asleep” — 熟睡的; 沉睡的****

A common fixed use.

Practice 24

> “The baby was ****sound asleep****.”

「寶寶正在****熟睡／睡得很沉****。」

Practice 25

> “He was still ****sound asleep**** when I left.”

「我離開時，他仍然****睡得很熟****。」

****sound asleep = 睡得非常深沉、不容易被吵醒的****

Here, ****sound**** works as an intensifying element in a fixed expression.

13. **soundly = deeply/firmly (睡眠) — 熟睡地; 沉沉地**

Practice 26

> “She slept **soundly** despite the noise.”

「雖然有噪音，她仍然**睡得很沉、很安穩**。」

Practice 27

> “The children were sleeping **soundly**.”

「孩子們正在**熟睡**。」

soundly — sleep = 以深沉、安穩而不易被打擾的方式入睡

14. **soundly = thoroughly/decisively (結果／擊敗) — 徹底地; 明顯地**

Practice 28

> “The team was **soundly** defeated.”

「球隊被**徹底擊敗，差距相當明顯**。」

Practice 29

> “The proposal was **soundly** rejected.”

「這項提案被**明確而徹底地否決**。」

soundly = 程度徹底、充分而沒有太大疑問地

15. **soundness = physical/structural condition (結構／身體) — 穩固程度; 健全狀況**

Meaning: The quality of being strong, healthy, intact, or free from serious defects.

Practice 30

> “Engineers checked the structural **soundness** of the bridge.”

「工程師檢查橋樑的**結構穩固性和完整程度**。」

Practice 31

> “The inspection confirmed the **soundness** of the building.”

「檢查確認了大樓的**結構安全和穩健程度**。」

soundness = 結構、身體或系統沒有重大缺陷並保持良好狀態的程度

16. **soundness = argument/decision/finance (論證／決定／財務) — 合理性; 可靠性; 穩健性**

Practice 32

> “The committee questioned the **soundness** of the argument.”

「委員會質疑這項論證的**邏輯可靠性和合理性**。」

Practice 33

> “Investors examined the financial **soundness** of the company.”

「投資者檢視公司的財務**穩健程度**。」

soundness = 某個論點、判斷或制度在邏輯、證據或穩定性方面是否可靠

Important distinction: **sound vs noise**

We have already curated **noise**, and this contrast is important.

sound

Neutral general term for something heard.

> “I heard a sound.”

「我聽到一個聲音。」

noise

often suggests sound that is:

- * unwanted
- * distracting
- * unpleasant
- * irregular

> “Traffic noise kept me awake.”

「交通噪音令我睡不著。」

So:

****all noise is sound, but not all sound is noise.****

Important distinction: **sound vs audio**

**sound**

Broad everyday word for what we hear.

**audio**

More technical and often refers to recorded, transmitted, or electronically processed sound.

> “sound quality”

> = 音質

> “audio file”

> = 音訊檔案

> “audio settings”

> = 音訊設定

For headphones, both ****sound quality**** and ****audio quality**** occur, but ****sound quality**** is extremely natural in consumer language.

Important distinction: **sound vs voice**

**sound**

any audible phenomenon.

voice

specifically the sound produced by a person speaking or singing.

> “I heard a strange sound.”

「我聽到奇怪的聲響。」

> “I recognized her voice.”

「我認得她的聲音／嗓音。」

Important distinction: **sound vs seem**

We curated **seem** earlier.

sound

judges something based particularly on what is heard or what someone says.

> “The plan sounds good.”

「這個計劃聽起來不錯。」

seem

is broader and can be based on any evidence or impression.

> “The plan seems good.”

「這個計劃看來不錯。」

Important distinction: **sound vs healthy**

When describing people or bodies:

healthy

broadly means in good health.

sound

often emphasizes **no weakness, defect, or injury**, and can sound more formal or specialist.

> “a healthy person”

> = 健康的人

> “a sound knee”

> = 結構／功能完好的膝部

Important distinction: **sound vs solid**

For structures or reasoning:

sound

= reliable, free from major weakness

solid

can mean physically firm, or figuratively strong/substantial

> “a sound argument”

> = 邏輯可靠的論點

> “a solid argument”

> = 有力、內容扎實的論點

They overlap, but **sound** emphasizes **validity/reliability**.

Important distinction: **sound quality vs volume**

These are not the same.

sound quality

= how good the audio is:

- * clarity
- * balance
- * detail
- * richness
- * distortion level

volume

= how loud or quiet it is.

A pair of headphones can be:

> **very loud but have poor sound quality**

= **音量很大, 但音質很差。**

Family-extension note

Following our Golden Manual, these are especially useful:

- * **sound quality** = 音質
- * **sound system** = 音響系統
- * **sound effect** = 音效
- * **sound recording** = 錄音
- * **soundproof** = 隔音的
- * **soundproofing** = 隔音處理／隔音材料
- * **sound wave** = 聲波
- * **sound asleep** = 熟睡
- * **sound advice** = 合理可靠的建議
- * **sound judgment** = 穩健合理的判斷
- * **financially sound** = 財務穩健
- * **sound the alarm** = 發出警報／敲響警鐘
- * **soundness** = 穩固性／合理性／穩健性

One useful derivative:

soundproof

> “The studio is completely soundproof.”

「錄音室具有完整的**隔音效果, 能阻隔聲音傳入或傳出**。」

This is a genuine useful family extension, even though **soundproof** is a compound rather than a separate sense of bare **sound**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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sound — audible phenomenon	人耳能夠聽到的聲音或聲響
sound — audio output	耳機、音響、樂器或錄音所呈現出的可聽音訊
sound — auditory character	某個聲音來源具有辨識度的音色、風格或整體聽感
sound + adjective	根據某人的聲音或說話內容判斷其似乎具有某種狀態
sound like	根據所聽到的聲音或資訊判斷, 像某人／某物／某種情況
sound — produce noise	發出可以被聽見的聲音
sound the alarm	發出警報; 亦可比喻公開警告某項危險
sound — physical/structural	身體、結構或物件狀況良好、穩固而沒有重大缺陷的
sound — advice/argument	有充分理據、邏輯可靠並值得信任的
sound — financial/business	財務穩定、基礎可靠而沒有重大弱點的
sound asleep	睡得非常深沉、不容易被吵醒的
soundly — sleep	以深沉安穩、不易受到干擾的方式睡眠
soundly — thoroughly	程度徹底、充分或明顯地
soundness — structural	結構或系統沒有重大缺陷、保持良好狀態的程度
soundness — reasoning/finance	論證、判斷或財務狀況在可靠性和穩健性方面的程度

For your original sentence

> “The ad mentioned practical features like comfort, battery life, and **sound quality**...”

The exact meaning is:

sound = 耳機播放出來、能被使用者聽見的音訊

and:

sound quality = 這些音訊在清晰度、細節、平衡、自然度和整體聽感方面的質素

So here the most natural Traditional Chinese is simply:

sound quality = 音質.

like the sound of + idea/plan/suggestion (構思／計劃／提議) — 聽起來覺得吸引; 喜歡這個主意

Meaning: To feel positive about an idea, plan, suggestion, or situation after hearing about it.

Practice 1

“We could spend the weekend by the sea.”

“I like the sound of that.”

「我們週末可以去海邊度假。」

「聽起來很不錯，我喜歡這個主意。」

Practice 2

“The new job includes flexible hours and remote work.”

“I like the sound of that.”

「新工作有彈性工時，而且可以遙距工作。」

「這個安排聽起來很吸引。」

like the sound of something = 聽到某個構思、安排或提議後，覺得它很吸引並產生好感

Here, sound refers figuratively to:

某件事被說出來後給人的整體印象

—not literal acoustic sound.

Negative form: not like the sound of + something — 聽起來覺得不妙／令人擔心

Practice 3

“The engine is making a strange clicking noise.”

“I don’t like the sound of that.”

「引擎正在發出奇怪的喀喀聲。」

「這聽起來不太妙。」

Practice 4

“They said the repairs could take several weeks.”

“I don’t like the sound of that.”

「他們說維修可能要幾個星期。」

「這個情況聽起來不太理想。」

not like the sound of something = 聽到某個消息或情況後，覺得它可能不好、令人擔心或不吸引